

Student Guide — primary / module-04-doshas

IKS Curriculum

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Student Workbook

Student Workbook — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Primary)

This workbook is yours to write in. Use it for vocab, exercises, and reflection across all 10 days.

Vocabulary tracker

Fill in as we go:

- *doṣa* — _____
- *vāta* — _____
- *pitta* — _____
- *kapha* — _____
- *prakṛti* — _____
- *vikṛti* — _____

Day-by-day notes

Day 1 — Three Doshas Introduction

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 2 — Vāta — The Motion Principle

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 3 — Pitta — The Transformation Principle

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 4 — Kapha — The Structure Principle

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 5 — Mapping to the Five Elements

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 6 — Prakṛti Self-Assessment

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 7 — Doṣa Rhythms in a Day

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 8 — Doṣa Rhythms Across Seasons

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 9 — Balance and Imbalance

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 10 — Synthesis and Project Pitch

What I learned:

One question I have:

Final reflection

After Day 10, write a paragraph: what is the most important thing you learned in this module?

Day 1 — Three Doshas Introduction

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Name vāta, pitta, kapha and recognise one observable trait of each.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *doṣa* (IAST: doṣa; lit. “humour / functional principle”)
- Three friends live inside us all the time:
 - **Wiggle** (*vāta*) — quick, lively, like wind
 - **Spark** (*pitta*) — warm, sharp, like fire
 - **Cozy** (*kapha*) — slow, soft, like a snug blanket

Show three picture cards (or draw the three on the board). Ask children: “*Which one feels most like you in the morning? Right now?*”

Each child draws one of the three friends in their notebook with one word that fits them today.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 2 — Vāta — The Motion Principle

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Identify vāta-style behaviours (quick, dry, cold, moving) in self and surroundings.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *vāta* (IAST: vāta; lit. “motion principle (wind, ākāśa+vāyu)”)
- *vāta* is the **wind friend** inside us.
- Today's word: *vāta* (say “VAH-tah”).

Stand up. Wiggle hands in the air like leaves. “*That's vāta — moving, light, quick.*”

Each child draws **Wiggle** — a small figure with movement lines around it. What does Wiggle like? (Cool weather, dancing, talking, running.)

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

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Day 3 — Pitta — The Transformation Principle

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Identify pitta-style behaviours (warm, sharp, focused, transforming).

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: *"What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"*

Today's idea (10 min)

- *pitta* (IAST: pitta; lit. "transformation principle (fire, tejas+ap)")
- *pitta* is the **fire friend** inside us.
- Today's word: *pitta* (say "PIT-tah").

Hold hands near a lit candle (safely, from a distance). *"Feel the warmth. That's the kind of friend Spark is — warm, bright."*

Each child draws **Spark** — a small figure with a glow around them. What does Spark like? (Sharp puzzles, focused work, learning fast, eating well.)

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

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Day 4 — Kapha — The Structure Principle

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Identify kapha-style behaviours (steady, cool, moist, structured).

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today’s idea (10 min)

- *kapha* (IAST: kapha; lit. “structure principle (cohesion, ap+pr̥thvī)”)
- *kapha* is the **cozy friend** inside us.
- Today’s word: *kapha* (say “KAH-pah”).

Hold a blanket or pillow. “*Cozy is warm, soft, slow, and holds you steady. Like a comfy hug.*”

Each child draws **Cozy** — a soft round figure. What does Cozy like? (Big meals, naps, sweet songs, looking after others.)

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

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Day 5 — Mapping to the Five Elements

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Connect each doṣa to its two constituent elements (vāta=ākāśa+vāyu, pitta=tejas+ap, kapha=ap+prthvī).

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: “What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?”

Today’s idea (10 min)

- *prakṛti* (IAST: prakṛti; lit. “innate constitution”)
- Vāta = ākāśa (space) + vāyu (air) — both light, both move.

- Pitta = tejas (fire) + ap (water) — fire that flows.
- Kapha = ap (water) + pṛthvī (earth) — wet earth holds shape.

Take the three friend drawings from earlier days. Beside each, draw the two elements that make that friend. Wiggle gets sky + wind. Spark gets fire + water. Cozy gets water + earth.

Sing the rhyme: “*Wiggle is sky and wind. Spark is fire and water. Cozy is water and earth.*”

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

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Day 6 — Prakṛti Self-Assessment

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Use a worksheet to estimate own dominant doṣa(s) — emphasising NOT diagnosis.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *vikṛti* (IAST: vikṛti; lit. “current imbalance”)
- Today: which friend is most like ME right now?

Ask three questions: 1. “*When you talk to friends, do you feel quick (Wiggle), focused (Spark), or steady (Cozy)?*” 2. “*At meal time, are you usually nibbling little bits (W), eating fast and hot (S), or eating slow and big (C)?*” 3. “*At sleep time, do you flip around (W), sleep just enough (S), or sleep deep (C)?*”

Each child colours a small chart with one star for each friend that fits them today. “*All three friends live in everyone. Today's stars are just for today — they can change tomorrow.*”

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

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Day 7 — Doṣa Rhythms in a Day

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Map the kapha-pitta-vāta cycle across morning/noon/evening hours.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: "What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"

Today's idea (10 min)

- *doṣa* (IAST: *doṣa*; lit. "humour / functional principle")
- The day has three parts where each friend takes the lead:
 - **Morning (Cozy time):** slow start, good for breakfast, gentle movement
 - **Middle of day (Spark time):** sharp focus, biggest meal, schoolwork
 - **Evening (Wiggle time):** creative play, light dinner, getting ready for bed

Draw a sun arc on paper. Mark "C" near the morning, "S" near noon, "W" near sunset. Children colour each section with a different colour and add one activity to each.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

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- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 8 — Doṣa Rhythms Across Seasons

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Map *doṣa* cycles to monsoon/summer/winter.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: "What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"

Today's idea (10 min)

- *vāta* (IAST: *vāta*; lit. "motion principle (wind, ākāśa+vāyu)")
- Each season has a special friend:
 - **Spring** — Cozy is busy melting away! (Allergies, sniffles.)
 - **Summer** — Spark is hot! (Sweating, drinking water.)
 - **Winter** — Wiggle is dry and cool! (Dry skin, blankets.)

Draw a tree in three seasons (bare → blossom → leaves) and write which friend lives there. Ask: "What did our family eat in summer? In winter? Why?"

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

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Day 9 — Balance and Imbalance

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Distinguish prakṛti (innate) from vikṛti (current state); recognise simple imbalance signs.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: "What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"

Today's idea (10 min)

- *pitta* (IAST: pitta; lit. "transformation principle (fire, tejas+ap)")
- Sometimes one friend gets too loud!
 - Wiggle too loud = jittery, can't sit still, dry mouth
 - Spark too loud = grumpy, hot, hangry
 - Cozy too loud = sleepy, heavy, sad

Story: "Imagine if all three friends are at a party. If one shouts too much, the others get tired."
Ask: "What helps Wiggle calm down? What helps Spark cool off? What helps Cozy wake up?"

Each child draws one friend in calm mode and one in too-loud mode.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

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- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 10 — Synthesis and Project Pitch

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Pitch the 7-day self-observation project and answer assessment quiz.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: *"What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"*

Today's idea (10 min)

- *kapha* (IAST: kapha; lit. "structure principle (cohesion, ap+pr̥thvī)")
- Today we say goodbye to the three friends — but they will stay with us!

Each child shares one favourite friend and one thing they learned about that friend. Make a class wall: three big drawings (Wiggle, Spark, Cozy) with each child's small drawing of them stuck around the big one.

Sing the friends-song together: *"Wiggle, Spark, Cozy — three friends inside, three friends inside, three friends inside me!"*

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

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- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Homework

Homework — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Primary)

Light daily tasks. Each takes 5–10 minutes.

1. **Day 1 — Three Doshas Introduction** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
2. **Day 2 — Vāta — The Motion Principle** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
3. **Day 3 — Pitta — The Transformation Principle** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
4. **Day 4 — Kapha — The Structure Principle** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
5. **Day 5 — Mapping to the Five Elements** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
6. **Day 6 — Prakṛti Self-Assessment** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
7. **Day 7 — Doṣa Rhythms in a Day** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
8. **Day 8 — Doṣa Rhythms Across Seasons** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
9. **Day 9 — Balance and Imbalance** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
10. **Day 10 — Synthesis and Project Pitch** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)

Notes

- Homework is intended to consolidate what was learned in class, not introduce new content.
- If a child struggles, the parent should consult the teacher rather than push.
- Capstone project days (Module 15) may have lighter daily homework so students can focus on the project.